Stephan Hobler

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Education

London School of Economics and Political Science — 2022–present
Ph.D. in Economics

London School of Economics and Political Science — 2020-2022
MRes in Economics (Distinction)

University of Oxford — 2018–2020
MPhil in Economics (Distinction)

University of Warwick — 2015–2018
BSc in Economics

References

Professor Wouter Den Haan
Department of Economics
London School of Economics
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Professor Matthias Doepke
Department of Economics
London School of Economics
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Professor Jonathon Hazell
Department of Economics
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Professor Maarten De Ridder
Department of Economics
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Job Market Paper

Worker Mobility and the Diffusion of Radical Technologies.

Abstract. The spread of new, transformative technologies often relies on specialized knowledge among workers and managers. When the required expertise is scarce, human capital and worker mobility can become bottlenecks to technology diffusion. To study these dynamics, I develop a theory in which firms and workers accumulate technology-specific expertise through mutual learning, and worker mobility is subject to search frictions. I calibrate the model to the diffusion of predictive AI among U.S. firms, matching empirical patterns of technology adoption and worker flows using comprehensive microdata from LinkedIn. Worker mobility emerges as a key driver of diffusion. When a new technology is introduced, adoption is initially slow due to the lack of experienced workers and concentrated only among the most productive firm-worker pairs. Diffusion then accelerates through the poaching of workers from early adopters, generating an S-shaped diffusion curve. Aggregate output follows a J-curve, with productivity gains taking time to materialize. A counterfactual matched to European-style labor markets with low mobility and long job tenures reveals a trade-off: the European economy delivers modestly higher steady-state output, but slows adoption by two-thirds and reduces welfare gains from the new technology by one-third—potentially contributing to transatlantic productivity gaps in technology-intensive sectors.

Publications

Multi-Layered Rational Inattention and Time-Varying Volatility. *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, Vol. 139, 2022.

Working Papers

Do Deficits Cause Inflation? A High Frequency Narrative Approach., with Jonathon Hazell

Why did we think wages are rigid for all those years?, with See-Yu Chan and Thijs van Rens
A front fixing approach to solving sovereign default models. Computational Note.

Work in Progress

Granular Search in the Product Market. *Preliminary draft.*
Intangible capital, leverage dynamics, and economic growth., with Johannes Matt

Teaching

Course Manager – EC2B1 Macroeconomics II, LSE	2023–2025
Class Teacher – EC2B1 Macroeconomics II, LSE	2022–2023
Class Teacher – EC210 Macroeconomic Principles, LSE	2021–2022
Class Teacher – Tools for Macroeconomists: Advanced Tools (Summer School)	2023,2024

Other Professional Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Maarten De Ridder, LSE	2024
Research Assistant to Prof. Joe Hazell, LSE	2021–2023
Research Assistant to Prof. Martin Ellison, University of Oxford	2020
Research Assistant to Prof. Thijs van Rens, University of Warwick	2017–2018

Awards & Grants

STICERD Grant 2024, LSE
Sir John Hicks Prize for outstanding doctoral student research, LSE
LSE Economics Department Scholarship
NOE TOP Stipendium
Examiner's Prize for Outstanding Performance in Economics for Third Year, University of Warwick
Oliver Hart Prize for Excellent Performance for Second Year, University of Warwick

Refereeing

American Economic Review, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Economica*

Other Skills

Technical: Julia, Python, Matlab, R
Languages: German (native), English (fluent)
Citizenship: Austria